

# The KRA channel — and how to work it Monday

Your lunch opened a real lane. This is everything we know, the questions to ask, and the names to know when Stephenson comes up.

## 01 · STATE OF PLAY

### What your lunch achieved

- **KRA wants to collaborate in Alberta** — the gate is a healthcare portfolio showing past relevant experience per consultant (you + Ian are building it).
- **They handed us a lane, unprompted:** "a nice spot for commissioning, because others don't want to do it" — and then proved it: they had to hire a Toronto firm *they didn't even know* (Stephenson) because no Vancouver structural engineer would take the work.
- **Two live follow-ups:** she's in Vancouver in ~2 weeks and open to a quick meeting with KRA's Vancouver BD + KOR; and you follow up **Monday**. Also on the clock: Fraser Health prequal — she said it's staged and slow, keep it moving.

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## 02 · YOUR QUESTION, ANSWERED

# Commissioning is not peer review

|                  | PEER REVIEW                                               | COMMISSIONING                                                                                                              |
|------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| When             | During design                                             | End of construction → opening                                                                                              |
| What             | Independent engineer reviews <i>another firm's</i> design | Verifying the <i>built</i> facility performs as designed                                                                   |
| In healthcare    | Owner-driven on major projects                            | <b>CSA Z8001</b> — mandated program, mostly mech/elec-led                                                                  |
| Structural slice | Review report on the design                               | Seismic restraint & anchorage verification, equipment-swap assessments in live hospitals, vibration checks for imaging/ORs |

## WHY THE UNLOVED WORK IS THE PRIZE

Every small commissioning scope is a real healthcare project line — exactly the past-relevant-experience currency KRA says their prime submissions require. Take the work nobody wants, build the portfolio KRA itself asked for, graduate to the structural design seat.

## 03 · KNOW STEPHENSON BETTER THAN KRA DOES

# Who actually did their commissioning

Stephenson Engineering, Toronto — since 2020 a company of **Salas O'Brien**, a US roll-up (40+ merged firms in ~10 years) whose platform pitch is engineering + facility planning + **commissioning**. That's why they say yes where Vancouver firms say no.

## THE TWIST WORTH KNOWING

Their "Vancouver office" is **inherited MEP turf from the 2023 Crossey Engineering merger** — one MEP associate, contact phone is a Toronto 416 number, and *no structural or commissioning person based in BC that we can find*. Their three BC healthcare credits (Royal Columbian tower, new Surrey Hospital & BC Cancer Centre, Dawson Creek Hospital) are all Crossey *MEP design* work — not structural, not commissioning-of-record.

| NAME TO KNOW      | ROLE                                                                               | WHERE     |
|-------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------|
| Aron McCallum     | Managing Principal                                                                 | Toronto   |
| Lawrence McSorley | Principal — Building Science lead; deep government relationships in Western Canada | Calgary   |
| Christian Guimond | VP & office leader (structural / building science / envelope)                      | Ottawa    |
| Daniel Hofland    | Associate — MEP (ex-Crossey); the only Vancouver-based name found                  | Vancouver |

- **Their weakness, in one line:** fly-in delivery. No BC structural or commissioning bench, no public BC seismic depth, and visible post-merger integration friction. A local, seismic-fluent firm that shows up in person wins that comparison.
- **The diligence question to plant (gently):** *"Was your commissioning handled by Stephenson's structural people in Toronto, or the ex-Crossey mechanical team?"* Whatever she answers tells us the exact scope to pitch — and makes KRA think about who they actually hired.

04 • MONDAY

## The follow-up script

1

### Scope question

"When you say commissioning — what exactly did Stephenson do for you? Which projects, and was it the mechanical program or the structural side (restraints, anchorage, vibration)?"

2

### Lock the meeting

Propose a specific slot for the Vancouver meeting while she's here, and ask who from KRA Vancouver BD will join.

3

### The bar to clear

"What would KRA need to see to give the next commissioning scope to a Vancouver firm instead?"

- **And take the Toronto favour:** your friend finding out what Stephenson's commissioning scope actually covered is intel we can't get publicly. Yes please.

## One room, two provinces

- **Objective:** convert the Alberta goodwill into one named first scope (a commissioning/verification pilot on a live KRA project), and open the BC non-health thread with their Vancouver BD in the same sitting.
- **Bring:** the healthcare portfolio piece (in progress with Ian) — led by seismic restraint, equipment, and vibration-sensitive work, in KRA's past-relevant-experience format.
- **Tone from your lunch, keep it:** "here to find opportunities to work with you" — no barriers. It worked.

## What's solid and what isn't

- Stephenson's corporate facts, names, and BC MEP credits: verified against their own and Salas O'Brien's pages.
- "Just started presence in Vancouver": her words at lunch — the public record shows only the inherited MEP office, so treat the structural/commissioning beachhead as *not yet real* until we see otherwise.
- No public evidence they've done CSA Z8001 healthcare commissioning anywhere — capability is claimed in marketing, not shown on projects. Your question #1 settles what KRA actually bought.